

# Empowering Education for Employability

Sathyabama is among the earliest institutions of Tamil Nadu that started as a technical educational center. Its role is significant in providing manpower to various industry sectors. Dr Mariazeena Johnson, Chancellor of this institution of higher learning, shares the journey and the vision forward.



**■ Dr. MARIAZEENA JOHNSON**  
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Chancellor

**Sathyabama Institute of Science and Technology, a deemed to be University, has completed 35 years since its inception in 1988. Could you highlight some defining milestones of this institution?**

Our institution attaining NAAC A++ grade, ABET recognition, Category I grade recognition from UGC, Consistent Placement record over the years, number of student startups we could able to produce due to consistent efforts in encouraging and developing

innovation ecosystem through "SEED MONEY GRANTS" to the innovative ideas of our students. Receiving 5 crores grant to our Technology Incubation Centre, our institution becoming Mentor to other institutions in guiding innovation, startup journey are other remarkable achievements.

**Could you share some interesting anecdotes with the Founder Chancellor of Sathyabama, Dr.Jeppiaar, that have proven to be useful when you became chancellor of the institution?**

Our founder chancellor always insisted upon discipline and foreseeing the requirements of NEXTGEN, these became handy in the planning and development policies related to the institution. Discipline of course remained as the basic fabric of our line of thought process in student progress.

**Sathyabama started as a technology and science institution in its early days. How many more new disciplines have you added to higher education and what are they?**

Sathyabama had a major transformation in terms of new disciplines that we have added. A shift from conventional studies to the disciplines that are most sought out by student community and industry are introduced in the recent past, namely, AI with Robotics / Machine learning, Cyber security, Block Chain technology, IoT, Data Science, Mechatronics, LL.M in Intellectual Property Laws are few to mention. These courses/disciplines are introduced to meet the present and future academic and industry requirements.

**Faculty is the core of all that happens on the campus. What do you have to say about the faculty that teaches the students and the pedagogy adopted?**

We ensure that our faculty competence is a fitting match to the stakeholder expectations. Upskilling and Reskilling are inherent process of our faculty appraisal and progression. Even during and post-pandemic stage the pedagogical transformation in the course instruction, evaluation by the faculty was very smooth and productive. Faculty upgraded the necessary digital techniques, adoption to online platforms is a testimony of their calibre and passion towards the profession.

**Today, when global boundaries have become seamless in terms of education and professional work, what are the innovative curriculums and teaching methodology that have you adopted for the students of Sathyabama?**

Entrepreneurship Essentials, Innovation and Entrepreneurship, Intellectual Property Rights, Venture Creation are few innovative courses we have introduced in our curriculum to meet changing global requirements. Our curriculum revision takes place periodically as well as the teaching methodology gets tuned to the futuristic academic requirements and challenges.